



Ubuntu Quickstart

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▶ See Also: Quickstart Installation Guides (quickstart.html), Security Considerations (security.html)

Introduction

This guide is intended to provide you with simple instructions on how to install Nagios from source (code) on Ubuntu and have it monitoring your local machine inside of 20 minutes. No advanced installation options are discussed here - just the basics that will work for 95% of users who want to get started.

These instructions were written based on an **Ubuntu 14.04 - Server** installation. They should work with most recent versions of Ubuntu with minor changes on some versions.

What You'll End Up With

If you follow these instructions, here's what you'll end up with:

- Nagios and the plugins will be installed underneath `/usr/local/nagios`
- Nagios will be configured to monitor a few aspects of your local system (CPU load, disk usage, etc.)
- The Nagios web interface will be accessible at `http://localhost/nagios/`

Required Packages

Make sure you've installed the following packages on your Ubuntu installation before continuing.

- Apache 2
- PHP
- GCC compiler and development libraries
- GD development libraries

You can use `apt-get` to install these packages by running the following commands:

```
sudo apt-get install apache2 libapache2-mod-php5 build-essential libgd-dev
```

1) Create Account Information

Become the root user.

```
sudo -s
```

Create a new *nagios* user account and give it a password.

```
/usr/sbin/useradd -m -s /bin/bash nagios
passwd nagios
```

You will need to also add a *nagios* group (if it's not created by default).

```
/usr/sbin/groupadd nagios
/usr/sbin/usermod -G nagios nagios
```

Create a new *nagcmd* group for allowing external commands to be submitted through the web interface. Add both the nagios user and the apache user to the group.

```
/usr/sbin/groupadd nagcmd
/usr/sbin/usermod -a -G nagcmd nagios
/usr/sbin/usermod -a -G nagcmd www-data
```

2) Download Nagios and the Plugins

Create a directory for storing the downloads.

```
mkdir ~/downloads
cd ~/downloads
```

Download the source code tarballs of both Nagios Core and the Nagios plugins (visit <https://www.nagios.org/download/> (<https://www.nagios.org/download/>) for links to the latest versions). These directions were tested with Nagios 4.2.1 and Nagios Plugins 2.1.3.

```
wget http://prdownloads.sourceforge.net/sourceforge/nagios/nagios-4.2.1.tar.gz
wget http://prdownloads.sourceforge.net/sourceforge/nagiosplug/nagios-plugins-2.1.3.tar.gz
```

3) Compile and Install Nagios Core

Extract the Nagios Core source code tarball.

```
cd ~/downloads
tar xzf nagios-4.2.1.tar.gz
cd nagios-4.2.1
```

Run the Nagios configure script, passing the name of the group you created earlier like so:

```
./configure --with-command-group=nagcmd
```

Compile the Nagios Core source code.

```
make all
```

Install binaries, init script, sample config files and set permissions on the external command directory.

```
make install
make install-init
make install-config
make install-commandmode
```

Don't start Nagios Core yet - there's still more that needs to be done...

4) Customize Configuration

Sample configuration files (config.html) have now been installed in the `/usr/local/nagios/etc` directory. These sample files should work fine for getting started with Nagios Core. You'll need to make just one change before you proceed ...

Edit the `/usr/local/nagios/etc/objects/contacts.cfg` config file with your favorite editor and change the email address associated with the `nagiosadmin` contact definition to the address you'd like to use for receiving alerts.

```
vi /usr/local/nagios/etc/objects/contacts.cfg
```

5) Configure the Web Interface

Install the Nagios Core web config file in the Apache conf.d directory.

```
make install-webconf
```

Create a `nagiosadmin` account for logging into the Nagios Core web interface. Remember the password you assign to this account - you'll need it later.

```
htpasswd -c /usr/local/nagios/etc/htpasswd.users nagiosadmin
```

Restart Apache to make the new settings take effect.

```
/etc/init.d/apache2 reload
```

☐ **Note:** Consider implementing the enhanced CGI security measures described here (cgisecurity.html) to ensure that your web authentication credentials are not compromised.

6) Compile and Install the Nagios Plugins

Extract the Nagios plugins source code tarball.

```
cd ~/downloads
tar xzf nagios-plugins-2.1.3.tar.gz
cd nagios-plugins-2.1.3
```

Compile and install the plugins.

```
./configure --with-nagios-user=nagios --with-nagios-group=nagios
make
make install
```

7) Start Nagios Core

Configure Nagios Core to automatically start when the system boots.

```
ln -s /etc/init.d/nagios /etc/rcS.d/S99nagios
```

Verify the sample Nagios Core configuration files.

```
/usr/local/nagios/bin/nagios -v /usr/local/nagios/etc/nagios.cfg
```

If there are no errors, start Nagios Core.

```
/etc/init.d/nagios start
```

8) Login to the Web Interface

You should now be able to access the Nagios Core web interface at the URL below. You'll be prompted for the username (*nagiosadmin*) and password you specified earlier.

```
http://localhost/nagios/
```

Click on the "Service Detail" navbar link to see details of what's being monitored on your local machine. It will take a few minutes for Nagios Core to check all the services associated with your machine, as the checks are spread out over time.

9) Other Modifications

If you want to receive email notifications for Nagios Core alerts, you need to install the mailx (Postfix) package.

```
sudo apt-get install mailx  
sudo apt-get install postfix
```

You'll have to edit the Nagios Core email notification commands found in */usr/local/nagios/etc/objects/commands.cfg* and change any *'/bin/mail'* references to *'/usr/bin/mail'*. Once you do that you'll need to restart Nagios Core to make the configuration changes live.

```
sudo /etc/init.d/nagios restart
```

Configuring email notifications is outside the scope of this documentation. Refer to your system documentation, search the web, or look to the Nagios Support Portal (<https://support.nagios.com>) or Nagios Community Wiki (<http://wiki.nagios.org>) for specific instructions on configuring your Ubuntu system to send email messages to external addresses.

10) You're Done

Congratulations! You successfully installed Nagios Core. Your journey into monitoring is just beginning. You'll no doubt want to monitor more than just your local machine, so check out the following docs ...

- Monitoring Windows machines ([monitoring-windows.html](#))
- Monitoring Linux/Unix machines ([monitoring-linux.html](#))
- Monitoring Netware servers ([monitoring-netware.html](#))
- Monitoring routers/switches ([monitoring-routers.html](#))
- Monitoring publicly available services (HTTP, FTP, SSH, etc.) ([monitoring-publicservices.html](#))